

RWS 290 Proposal Gantt Chart Assignment

Background

Gantt charts are great management tools for planning writing projects. They help teams avoid conflicting individual timetables and allow all team members focus on—and take responsibility for—the most critical tasks required to complete a project.

Requirements

I'd like you to create a simple Gantt chart that a) identifies the tasks you will undertake to complete the report in one column of a table, b) identifies a date that each of those tasks will be completed, and c) assigns leadership responsibilities to those tasks in individual cells arranged in a date column.

The chart will represent a **course timeline** divided by class dates that begins today and ends on the date you submit the final report. I will review your chart with your group soon.

Process Steps

There are seven basic steps to completing this task:

1. In your group, review the project requirements on the *Report Project* project description that I passed out two weeks ago, and make a **comprehensive** list of all the major tasks to complete the report. List **everything**.
2. Arrange the tasks in the order your group thinks they should be completed.
3. Identify the team member responsible for each task. If all group members will be working on the task (e.g., practicing the presentation), identify **one member** who will be responsible for leading that task. You must all agree on this division of labor.
4. Determine **start** and **end** dates for all tasks.
5. Transfer the list of tasks to the left column of the *RWS 290 Report Gantt Chart* template in the Report Project folder on Blackboard (and reprinted on the reverse of this sheet). Then move to the individual date columns and type the initials of the person responsible for completing the task in the **individual cell** associated with that task and shade that cell. See the sample template. NOTE: You **must** use this MS Word template to complete the chart.
6. Provide a legend for the initials you typed into the individual cells.
7. Print the document for class. The chart is due next week.

Take this simple assignment seriously, and think the project through. The Gantt chart for the report is more than a document designed to manage the project. It's a **contract** between your group members (and me); each member will be held accountable for, and evaluated on, their portion of the work. Among other criteria, you'll be graded on the breadth and depth of tasks listed.